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AI LITERACY AND ETHICS

A community-based education intervention to improve AI literacy and ethical use of AI in the government schools of Bihar, India.

"because living in digitalizing societies require new educational practices, ethical reflection, critical thinking, responsible design practices and new skills given the implications for the labor market, employability, and civic participation."

Recommendation on the Ethics of Artificial Intelligence UNESCO, 2021

What is AI Literacy and Ethical Use?

Functional Literacy
Knowledge of how AI works, how to access it (AI as a composite voice)

Ethical Literacy
Responsible and ethical use of AI (accuracy, bias, reliability)

Rhetorical Literacy
Effective use of langugae to achieve a goal. (agency, own voice as an author)

Pedagogical Literacy
Integrate teaching and learning practice with AI to support student learning and development.

Deliverables

AI Literacy Modules
- Curated from open credible resources.
- Bilingual instructions.

Training
- Community trainers (4-6 weeks).
- Teachers (1 week).

Tech Support
- Subscriptions through private partnerships (Google/ OpenAI).

Impact
- Ethical Impact Assessment.
- M&E.

Feedback
- Weekly inputs from teachers.
- Grievance redressal channels.

Project Timeline

Stage 01 — DISCOVERY PHASE
Identify pilot schools.
District: Madhubani, Bihar.

Stage 02 — PLANNING AND TRAINING PHASE
Develop training modules and define project milestones. Bootcamp for trainers.

Stage 03 — EXECUTION PHASE
Train govt. teachers. Trainers and Teachers co-teach AI classes

Stage 04 — REVIEW PHASE
Year 1 end: Two mini-projects by studnets. Test scores evaluation. Expand to more schools in Year 2.

Bihar: Place of birth, and much more!


Nalanda University
Credit: BBC

Key Stakeholders

Government
- School Education Department, Govt. of Bihar
- District Education Office (DEO), and DIET
- School Principal, Headmaster, SMCs
- Panchayati Raj Institutions (GP/Block)

Primary Beneficiariies
- Govt. Teachers (Grades 6-9)
- Students (Grades 6-9)
- Community-based Trainers

Funding, Knowledge & Tech Partners
- Central Square Foundation (AI Samarth)
- Stanford | Teaching Commons
- Tech Organizations (Google/Open AI)
- Tata Trust/ NGOs

Potential Concerns & Safeguards/Incentives

Potential Concerns	Safeguards/Incentives
Low digital infrastructure	• Offline-first content • Mobile based access
Misuse or misinformation	• AI ethics module • Trainer and teacher guidance • Controlled environment-Group chat IDs managed by teachers
Trainer/Teacher dropout from the program	• Monthly stipend for trainers • Gift cards for teachers • Monthly Community of Practice sessions
Community resistance	• Local language, bi-lingual instructions • Inclusive content • Parent consent for tech device use

Theory of Change

INPUTS
- AI literacy modules for trainers, teachers, students (Grades 6–9).
- Short trainer bootcamp (20–30 hrs., NEP-aligned).
- Offline-first kit (printables) + weekly AI period in timetable.

OUTPUTS
- Trainers and teachers are co-teaching classes.
- Students complete AI/civic mini-projects.

INTERMEDIATE OUTCOMES
- Trainers gain facilitation skills and employability.
- Teachers & students understand basic and ethical AI use.
- Teachers use AI to design practice questions/checklists.
- Students complete at least 2 AI mini-projects per year.

FINAL OUTCOMES
- Improved learning outcomes (steady gains in tests/exams).
- Safer, kinder school climate (less misinformation, more trust).
- Strong community of practice around AI & learning.

Assumptions
- AI literacy can improve ethical, informed AI use and learning outcomes in govt. schools.
- Buy in of all stakeholders.
- Trainers, teachers, students have access to an internet connected device.

Assumptions
- Local youth are adequately trained as facilitators.
- Positive reception and regular engagement by all parties.

Assumptions
- Trainers can leverage this experience for better job opportunities.

Assumptions
- Regular AI use is sustained throughout the year.
- Access to AI leads to improved scores and more equitable learning opportunities.
- No harm is caused.

Education and Peace

Education is the foundation on which peaceful societies are built.

"positive education outcomes are related to higher levels of positive peace. Conversely, the proportion of disengaged youth negatively correlates with positive peace."

-Institute for Economics & Peace, and GPE, 2024

"Education, in all its forms and dimensions, in and out of classrooms, can and should be a pathway to bringing about lasting peace."

-UNDP

Budget Category	Estimated Cost INR	Details
Trainers' stipend	₹14,40,000	₹10K/month × 6 trainers × 24 months
Teacher incentives	₹72,000	₹1,500 × 12–15 teachers/ Gift vouchers
Training materials & prints	₹1,50,000	Offline toolkits + posters
Tech Access	₹2,00,000	Internet + GenAI subscriptions
Monitoring & Evaluation	₹50,000	Pre/post tests, surveys
Admin and logistics	₹80,000	Refreshments, transport
Total cost estimate: ₹20–22 Lakh (~$27–29K USD)		

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